

SUPPLEMENT: HOW TO USE DURING, FOR, WHILE AND IN

DURING is a preposition which is used before a noun (during + noun) to say when something happens. It does not tell us how long it happened. For example:

- "Nobody spoke **during** the presentation."
- "We get plenty of snow here **during** the winter."

WHILE is used to talk about two things that are happening at the same time. The length of time is not important. Remember that while is used with a subject and a verb (while + subject + verb). For example:

- "The phone rang **while** I was watching TV."
- "I met him **while** we were studying in the library."

FOR is a preposition which is used with a period to say how long something goes on:

- "Simon has been sleeping **for** 8 hours."
- "We waited **for** 30 minutes outside your house."

IN is typically used to specify a "calendar" time, which may be as small as a moment or as large as a century.

- "We are on vacation **in** July." NOT "We are on vacation **during** July."

IN is also commonly used to determine exactly when an activity happens.

- "We stayed there **in** July, not **in** August." NOT "We stayed there **during** July, not **during** August."

PRACTICE:

Complete the following sentences (1 - 34) by filling in the blank spaces with ONE of the following the words:

DURING / WHILE / FOR / IN

- (1) I've been meaning to call you _____ some time.
- (2) He fell asleep _____ the meeting.
- (3) We all stayed inside _____ the storm.
- (4) Someone stole my bag _____ I was riding on the train.
- (5) _____ summer it's too hot to work.
- (6) The dog was barking _____ she was trying to watch TV.
- (7) Please don't smoke _____ I'm eating.
- (8) Bats sleep _____ the day.
- (9) They've been out of the office _____ ages.
- (10) I started this website _____ 1999.
- (11) He kept talking to me _____ I was trying to read.
- (12) His mobile phone rang twice _____ the film.
- (13) They work _____ the night and sleep by day.
- (14) He slept _____ ten hours.
- (15) There were huge advances in aviation technology _____ the Second World War.
- (16) I read it _____ you were drying your hair.
- (17) "I'm going to the post office." " _____ you're there can you get me some stamps?"
- (18) Do you think we will go to Jupiter _____ the future?
- (19) The traffic in the city gets even worse _____ the summer.
- (20) I haven't played tennis _____ years.
- (21) _____ I was in Italy I went to see Alessandro.
- (22) The work that the students do _____ the year will count towards their final degrees.
- (23) I'm acting as deputy _____ the boss is away.
- (24) She showered and dressed before he woke _____ the morning.
- (25) I found these photos _____ I was cleaning out my cupboards.
- (26) She's out of the office _____ a few days next week.
- (27) The city centre is quite lively _____ the day, but it's totally dead at night.
- (28) I thought I heard him come in _____ we were having dinner.
- (29) You're not allowed to talk _____ the exam.
- (30) I'd like to take advantage of the sports facilities _____ I'm here.
- (31) I didn't drink at all _____ I was pregnant.
- (32) I'm just going to lie down _____ an hour or so.
- (33) I gained a lot of weight _____ I was on holiday.
- (34) I attended university _____ one year only.